

Build Without Words

One scene. Many hands. Zero talking.

GROUPS OF 3-6 · ~10 MINUTES · PENCILS OR MARKERS · NO PREP — WORKS AS A CALM-DOWN OR TRANSITION

1. No talking, no pointing, no mouthing words. Silence is the whole game.
2. Take turns: about 30 seconds each, then slide the sheet to your left.
3. Add to the scene. Never cross out or draw over what someone made.
4. Three rounds each, then stop, sit back, and admire what nobody planned.

THE SCENE — start anywhere

Teacher's Quick Guide

Build Without Words — everything useful, nothing else.

WHY IT WORKS

Silence removes negotiation, which removes conflict. The group coordinates through the drawing itself — it's teamwork with the arguing surgically removed.

HOW TO RUN IT

One sheet per group, pencils out, point at rule 1. The room goes quiet on its own.

AS A CALMING TOOL

This is a legitimate transition activity: after recess, before a test, during an overstimulated afternoon. Ten silent minutes that feel like a game.

MIXED AGES

Nothing to read beyond four rules, nothing to write. Fives and twelves can share a sheet.

IF SOMEONE TALKS

Their next turn is a single dot. House rule — enforce it with a smile.

KEEP THE ART

Date the sheets and keep them. A month of silent scenes makes a surprisingly good wall.

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GRID VARIANT: each artist owns one panel — but the scene must connect across every border. Roads, rivers, wires, weather: make it one world.

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